

GUIDE 03

What an Internal Audit Actually Involves

Internal audits sound intimidating, but they're a structured, predictable process. Here's what to expect.

**STEP 1****Planning**

An audit scope, schedule, and checklist are prepared against the relevant standard's clauses and your own procedures.

**STEP 2****Opening Meeting**

The auditor confirms scope, timing, and people involved with the process owner before any evidence is reviewed.

**STEP 3****Evidence Gathering**

The auditor reviews records, observes work being done, and talks to staff to check the process matches what's documented.

**STEP 4****Findings**

Any gaps are recorded as observations or nonconformances, each with a reference to the specific requirement not being met.

**STEP 5****Closing Meeting**

Findings are presented back to the team on the day — no surprises later — along with an overall assessment.

**STEP 6****Corrective Action**

Process owners investigate the root cause of each finding and implement a fix, which is verified at the next audit.